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SUPERSEDING
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July 19, 1967 and
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January 10, 1962

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

INK, DUPLICATING MACHINE STENCIL, PASTE, BLACK

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for one type and two compositions of paste ink for use with stencil-process duplicating machines. The ink is formulated for use on hard-sized and mimeograph papers.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and compositions. The paste stencil ink shall be of the water-in-oil emulsion type and of the following compositions, as specified (see 6.1).

Composition A - For use on single-cylinder (drum-type), internally inked machines.
Composition B - For use on dual-cylinder externally inked machines.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-121 - Paper, Bond and Writing: White and Colored.
UU-P-388 - Paper, Mimeograph.
UU-P-545 - Paper; Stencil, Duplicating Machine, Dry-Process.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141 - Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials, Methods of Inspection, Sampling, and Testing.
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Bid samples. Each bidder shall submit with his bid two cartridges or tubes of the composition ink he proposes to furnish, for the purpose of testing for compliance with the requirements of this specification prior to award. The cartridge or tube shall contain the volume of ink, and shall be adaptable for use with the inking system of the manufacturer's make and model number of stencil duplicating machine specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order. (See 5.1.1 and 6.1).

3.2 Material and workmanship. The ink shall be a water-in-oil emulsion ink. The manufacturer is given wide latitude in the selection of materials and processes of manufacturer provided the ink produced is uniform and homogeneous and otherwise meets the requirements specified herein. The ink shall not contain oil soluble dyes or toners. It shall be free from caking, skinning, lumps or coarse particles, separated materials, and any materials that would tend to dry on the cylinder rollers, in the cylinder drum, or on the ink pad or tend to close or obstruct the openings in applicable style cylinders.

3.3 Consistency (composition A only). The consistency of composition A ink shall measure 500 to 1200 seconds at 25°C. when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.4 Performance. The ink shall not cause deterioration of the coating or base tissue of the stencil sheet and shall produce acceptable reproduction on both sides of the mimeograph paper when tested as specified in 4.3.3.3. When run with the specified papers (see 4.3.3.1.1 and 4.3.3.1.2), the ink shall produce the required number of clean and clear, black-image duplicated copies without strike-through or set off sufficient to interfere with the legibility of the finished work on either side of the specified mimeograph paper. The ink shall not show an oily halo around character outlines when mimeographed on the specified paper. When the printed copies are stacked, there shall be no objectional transfer of ink from one sheet to the next. The ink shall not run or drip off cylinders or drums, shall not leak, and shall not clog the stencil carrier, ink distributor, and other components of the machine, as applicable. (See 6.2).

3.5 Color. Reproduction of copies produced during the performance test (4.3.3.3) shall be uniformly black and clearly legible.

3.6 Separation. The ink shall pass the tests specified in 4.3.1.1 and 4.3.4.

3.7 Specific gravity. (See 4.3.5).

3.7.1 Composition A. The specific gravity of the ink shall be not greater than 1.040 at 25°C.

3.7.2 Composition B. The specific gravity of the ink shall be not greater than 1.100 at 25°C.

3.8 Fading. Ink impressions shall remain uniformly black with negligible loss in color value upon completion of the fading test specified in 4.3.6.

3.9 Odor. The ink shall at no time during a duplicating operation have or develop an objectionable odor.

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3.10 Shelf life. The ink in original unopened containers (tubes) and not subjected to extremes of temperature and humidity, shall retain its utility and serviceability as defined by this specification for not less than 12 months from date of receipt by the Government. There shall be no appreciable settling or separation of pigment under the temperature and humidity conditions specified for the period of time cited.

3.11 Drying time (smudging). Upon completion of the run of 4,000 copies in the performance test of 4.3.3.3, the ink shall be sufficiently set on the first 1,000 sheets run within this time to permit handling and backup of the specified sheets without smudging (see 4.3.7).

3.12 Setoff and strike-through. Neither of these characteristics shall be sufficient to interfere with the legibility of the finished work on either side of the paper (see 4.3.8).

3.13 Damage to stencil. The ink shall not cause the stencil to become tacky, fill in, or otherwise destroy the stencil either during the performance test of 5,000 copies (4.3.3.3) or after storage in a folder for 24 hours as specified in 4.3.9.

3.14 Leakage. The consistency of the ink shall be such that it will not flood or leak on the machine with which it is used, when the machine is inked in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions.

3.15 Usage instructions (composition B only). Comprehensive instructions for fitting the tube to the ink pump shall be provided by the manufacturer, and shall be enclosed with each tube of ink (see 5.1.1), or may be printed on the tube.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and examination.

4.2.1 Size of lot. The lot shall consist of all paste ink manufactured as one batch and packaged for use in a specific model of stencil machine, as specified (see 6.1).

4.2.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container prepared for delivery and selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Construction.	Tubes and cartridges: Not as specified.
Workmanship.	Boxes: Inadequate stapling and application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps and loose strapping. Case liner missing, damaged, or incorrectly constructed. Distortion of container. Tubes not crimped properly; leakage of ink.
Quantities	Number of items per container not as specified.

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4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Lumps and skin tests.

4.3.1.1 Lumps and skin. A portion of paste ink from sample tube shall be placed on a plate glass. Flatten the ink with a spatula or knife, spreading it back and forth until a thin layer of the ink is formed on the plate. During this action observe the ink for particles of skin or lumps, and compliance with 3.2, as applicable. If any skin or lumps, caking, or separated materials are observed, further tests shall not be conducted and the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3.2 Consistency (composition A only). The consistency shall be measured on a Stormer, General Purpose Viscometer with a cylindrical type rotor, using the following modified Stormer method.

4.3.2.1 Apparatus.

Stormer viscometer, general purpose (catl. no. 9809)
Test cup with side vanes (catl. no. 9812-C)
Rotor, cylindrical type (catl. no. 9812-L)

All catl. nos. are from Arthur H. Thomas Co., 3rd & Vine Streets, Philadelphia, PA 19105.

Thermometers, two (ASTM, 17C Saybolt Viscosity, Range 19° to 27°C)
Stopwatch
Standard Viscosity Oil
S-600 (13.79 poises at 25°C)
(This oil can be procured from Cannon Instrument Co., P. O. Box 16, State College, PA 16801.)

4.3.2.2 Standardization of Stormer Viscometer. After setting up viscometer, the cup is filled to 1/4-inch above the side vanes with S-600 oil. The test cup is placed in the water bath, and the platform raised until the oil covers the rotor to a depth of 1/4-inch. The stop knuckle is set so all future measurements will be taken in the same position. A thermometer is inserted in both the water bath and test cup and the temperature of the water bath adjusted so the entire test sample temperature will be 25° ± 0.1°C., after which thermometer is removed from the test cup. Sufficient weight, approximately 200 grams, is attached to the pulley line to give 9.55 seconds per poise per 100 revolutions of the rotor. The spindle should be rotating at the time the count is started.

4.3.2.3 Procedure. The majority of air bubbles in the sample to be tested should be removed by shaking or stirring before sample is poured into the test cup, which is filled to 1/4-inch above the side vanes. The test cup is placed in the water bath and the platform raised until the ink covers the rotor to a depth of 1/4-inch. A thermometer is inserted in both the water bath and test cup and the temperature of the water bath adjusted so the entire test sample temperature will be 25° ± 0.1°C., after which thermometer is removed from the test cup. The brake is released and the drive weight allowed to fall free. The spindle should be rotating when the count is started. The number of seconds required for 100 revolutions of the spindle is measured and recorded as Stormer viscosity.

4.3.3 Performance (see 3.4, 5.1.1 and 6.2).

4.3.3.1 Test materials and machines.

4.3.3.1.1 Mimeograph copy paper. The copy paper used in the performance test (4.3.3.3) shall conform to type III, 40-pound (17 x 1,000) chemical-wood mimeograph paper of UU-P-388.

4.3.3.1.2 Paper, stencil, duplicating machine. Stencils conforming to UU-P-545, capable of producing 5,000 legible copies, shall be prepared for tests of composition A or B ink, as applicable, by typing 30 lines, 6 inches long, using all the letters, both upper and lower case, and all the numerals and symbols. Each stencil shall be prepared on an electric typewriter with elite type that has been cleaned and a platen having a Shore durometer, type A reading of 88-92. The typewriter pressure shall be set so that all characters cut clear and clean with no apparent cutting of the stencil.

4.3.3.1.3 Stencil duplicating machine. The performance and separation test for composition A paste ink shall be made on a single-cylinder (drum-type), internally inked, electrically operated stencil-duplicating machine having maximum copy speed of not less than 120 ± 5 copies per minute. The performance and separation test for composition B paste ink shall be made on a dual-cylinder, externally inked, electrically operated, stencil-duplicating machine equipped with automatic inking and having a maximum copy speed of not less than 120 ± 5 copies per minute.

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4.3.3.2 Preparation for test runs (4.3.3.3).

4.3.3.2.1 Composition A. The stencil printer shall be clean and contain a paste ink cylinder, impression roller, ink pad and protective cover recommended by the manufacturer. The impression roller pressure and placement of the ink pad and protective cover shall be as stipulated by the manufacturer. Two or three tubes of sample composition A paste ink shall be manually squeezed into the cylinder after which the cap shall be replaced. The paper feeler pins shall then be blocked and the stencil printer turned on (feed rollers locked out of feeding position) for about 100 revolutions (at which time the ink pad should be well inked up in the diaphragm area). The stencil, prepared as specified in 4.3.3.1.2, shall then be placed on the stencil printer which shall be set to run (see 4.3.3.3) at a speed of 120 ± 5 copies per minute.

4.3.3.2.2 Composition B. The stencil printer shall be clean and contain a stencil carrier, an impression roller, and ink rollers of the kind recommended by the manufacturer. The impression roller pressure shall be as stipulated by the manufacturer. An unused ink distributor shall be fitted to the machine and a fresh cartridge or tube of sample composition B paste ink affixed to the distributor.

The machine should be switched on or handle turned and the inking system shall be actuated until the ink is observed to discharge from the tube in the distributor until a thin and even flow of ink is established on the carrier. The stencil (4.3.3.1.2) shall be placed on the machine which shall be set to run (see 4.3.3.3) at a speed of 120 ± 5 copies per minute.

4.3.3.3 Test runs. Run 4,000 copies, using sample composition A or B ink, as applicable. Reserve the first 1,000 copies until completion of the run. Take the reserved sheets and back up or mimeograph on the reverse side of the printed sheets, completing a 5,000-copy run. Remove stencil and proceed with the damage to stencil test (4.3.9). Cover the stencil printer without cleaning down. Examine copies for compliance with 3.4 and other applicable requirements specified herein.

4.3.3.4 Tube performance (composition B only). Take a fresh new tube of sample composition B paste ink, attach to machine as in preparation for copy run. Remove silk screen, inking rollers and stencil clamp and place a sheet of approximately 20-pound paper under the ink distributor so that it hangs down over the lower cylinder. The machine should be switched on or handle turned. Mechanically activate the inking system until the ink is observed to discharge from the tube in the distributor. Continue to mechanically activate the ink system until the tube is empty. Examine for compliance with 5.1.1.

(Note. - By placing the specified paper under the distributor, the ink will discharge from the ink distributor onto the paper and save considerable time in cleaning up the machine. The sheet of paper can be renewed as required.)

4.3.4 Separation.

4.3.4.1 Composition A. Preparation for test shall be as specified in 4.3.3.2.1, as applicable. After completion of the damage to stencil test (4.3.9), place a new, freshly typed test stencil on the machine and set printer to run at a speed of 120 ± 5 copies per minute. Run 200 copies on mimeograph paper (4.3.3.1.1) and then examine for evidence of separation of ink vehicle or clogging of applicable machine parts.

4.3.4.2 Composition B. Preparation for test shall be as specified in 4.3.3.2.2, as applicable. After completion of the damage to stencil test (4.3.9), actuate the inking system and again observe the ease with which the ink film is established on the carrier. Affix a new, freshly typed test stencil, and set printer to run at a speed of 120 ± 5 copies per minute. Run 200 copies on mimograph paper (4.3.3.1.1) and then examine for evidence of separation of ink vehicle or clogging of the stencil carrier on the ink distributor.

(Note. - Ink separation will show on early copies as oily blotches while stencil carrier clogging will show in later copies as broken copy.)

4.3.4.3 Compositions A and B. After each of the above separation tests remove the new stencil, replace the stencil used in the performance test (4.3.3), and run 100 impressions. These impressions should be equal in quality to the last 100 copies of the performance test. If these impressions show the stencil to have deteriorated during storage, the ink shall be considered to have caused the damage. If the freshly type stencil shows ink separation or clogging of stencil carrier, ink distributor, or other applicable machine parts, it will not be necessary to re-run the original stencil.

(Note. - A feathery edge does not indicate separation.)

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4.3.5 Specific gravity. The specific gravity of the ink shall be determined with a pycnometer bottle at 25°C., in accordance with test method No. 4183 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

4.3.6 Fading test. A specimen for the fading test shall be taken from the first 100 copies made in the performance test (4.3.3) and exposed for a period of 48 hours to the radiation from a glass-enclosed carbon-arc such as the Fade-Ometer described in method No. 5660 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191. Examine for compliance with 3.8.

4.3.7 Drying of ink (smudge test). At any time after running approximately 1,000 copies of the specified runs (4.3.3.3), remove one copy of the printed sheets as it is delivered from the machine and conduct smudge test (4.3.7.1).

4.3.7.1 Smudge test. Take a printed sheet which has been allowed to dry as indicated in 3.11 and place it on a smooth, flat surface with the printed side up, and then cover with a clean sheet of mimeograph paper. Place a 100-gram, round, 3/4-inch-diameter weight on one edge of the paper and draw the clean sheet of mimeograph paper and weight slowly across the printed sheet. This test shall be made at least twice. Examine copy after each test for evidence of smudge.

4.3.8 Set off and strike-through. The first and last 100 copies of the performance test (4.3.3.3) shall be examined after 24 hours for set off and strike-through and for vehicle stain around the characters.

4.3.9 Damage to stencil. Remove the stencil from the machine (4.3.3.3), place it between several sheets of mimeograph paper and blot off the ink. Examine the stencil and report any tack, stickiness, or breakdown of the stencil coating. File in an absorbent folder for 24 hours and then re-examine for these defects.

4.3.9.1 Method for filing stencils. Open file folder on a flat surface, place the stencil on one side of the folder, inked side up; close the folder and lightly press the hand over the folder once to absorb ink from the stencil before filing.

4.3.10 Volume (net contents, weight). Unless otherwise specified, test shall be conducted as follows: Not less than 10 unit containers (tubes) shall be weighed. Each individual weight shall be noted. The empty weight of equal number of unit containers shall be determined. Using this tare weight of ink in each of the weighed unit containers. Determine the specific gravity of the ink by pycnometric methods (an accurately calibrated specific gravity bottle may be used). Divid the specific gravity into the net weight of the weighed sample containers to determine the volume of each. The volume of each container shall be not less than that declared on the label.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Tubes. The ink shall be furnished in individual tubes containing the volume of ink specified for use with the make and model number of stencil duplicating machine specified in the invitation for bids, contract or order (see 3.1 and 6.1). The filled tube of ink shall be adaptable for use with the inking system of the manufacturer's make and model number of stencil duplicating machine as specified (see 6.1). The tube shall be designed to provide for efficient and complete utilization of the ink contained therein, and shall not leak in transit or storage. The tubes shall be constructed for composition A or B ink as specified in 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2.

5.1.1.1 Tubes for composition A ink. The tubes for composition A ink shall be fabricated from polyethylene with a 7/16-20 neck finish. The bottom of the tubes shall be heat sealed; a minimum of 1/8-inch in actual sealed width, which shall form a leak proof seal or shall be equivalently constructed to form a leakproof seal. Each tube shall be provided with a plastic cap the same color as the ink.

5.1.1.2 Tubes for composition B ink. The tubes for composition B ink for use with a vacuum distribution pump on the duplicating machine specified (see 6.1) shall be fabricated from lead alloy or polyethylene. The bottom of the lead alloy tube shall be folded two and one-half or three folds with a squeeze crimp to provide a leakproof seal. The bottom of the polyethylene tube shall be heat sealed a minimum of 1/8-inch in actual sealed width which shall form a leakproof seal or shall be equivalently constructed to form a leakproof seal. Each tube shall be provided with a plastic cap the same color as the ink.

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5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit packaging.

5.1.2.1.1 Composition A ink. Each filled tube of composition A ink shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2.1.2 Composition B ink. Each filled lead alloy tube of composition B ink shall be inserted in a two section tray fabricated from molded polystrene. Each section shall be molded to the contour of the filled tube providing a snug-fit when the two sections are joined. The tray shall be secured with black polyester pressure-sensitive tape having a minimum width of 1/4 inch or with a polyethylene shrink wrap. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the tray shall be provided with an end opening making the tube cap visible. Each filled polyethylene tube of composition B ink shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level B. The filled tubes of composition A or B ink shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1.1 and 5.1.2.1.2, respectively.

5.1.4 Level C. The filled tubes of ink shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration, corrosion and damage from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of filled tubes of the same composition ink in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and reinforced in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four unit packages of filled tubes of the same composition ink shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with method I of the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The ink shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in shipping containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 and the following additional markings:

Unit packages. Each unit package shall be marked as follows:

Federal stock number.
Federal item identification.
Volume of contents. (U. S. fluid ounces)
Batch number.
Color of ink.
Manufacturer's make and model number of stencil duplicating machine applicable for the use of the filled tube of ink.
Specification number.
Date of manufacture.

Shipping container.

Composition of ink.
Manufacturer's make and model number of stencil duplicating machine applicable for the use of the filled tube of ink.
Batch number.
Color of ink.
Date of manufacture.

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TEST CUP WITH SIDE VANES

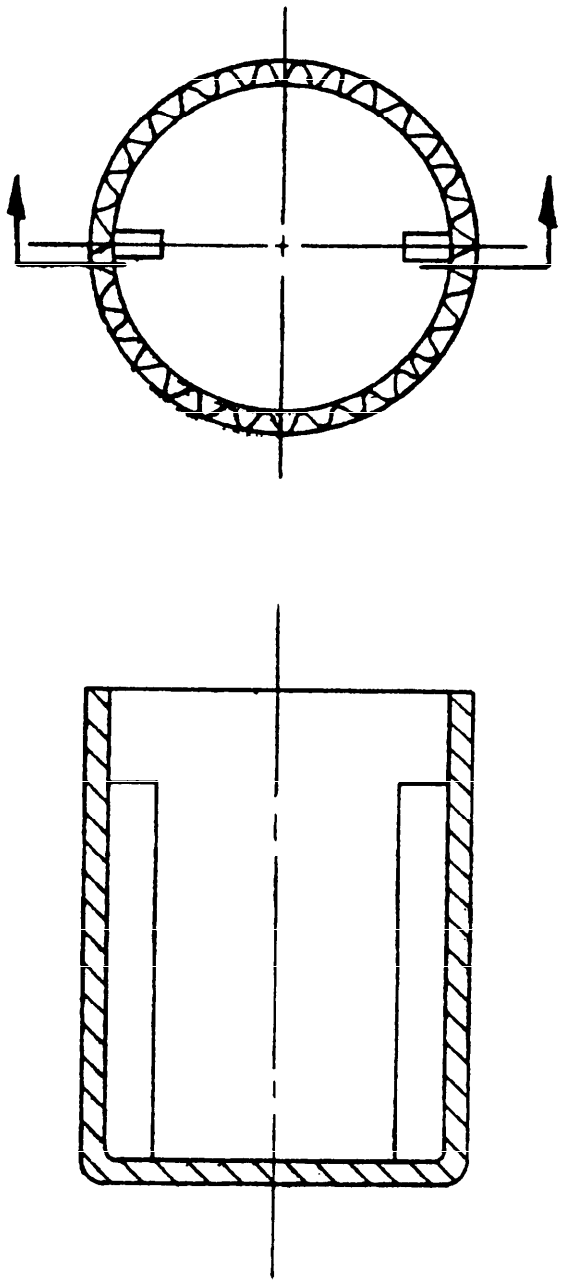


FIGURE 1

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5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Composition of ink required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Manufacturer's make and model number of stencil duplicating machine with which the tube of ink is intended to be used (see 3.1 and 5.1).
(d) Quantity of unit packages of tubes required in shipping container (see 5.2.1).
(e) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).
(f) End opening not required in tray (see 5.1.2.1.1).

6.2 Performance (composition B). An even, thin film of ink on the cylinders should be sufficient to produce the copies required in the performance test of 4.3.3; over-inking should be avoided.

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